



Department Of Public Works FY27 Budget Presentation

William Bernard, DPW Director, March 12 , 2026



Department Overview



Key Services

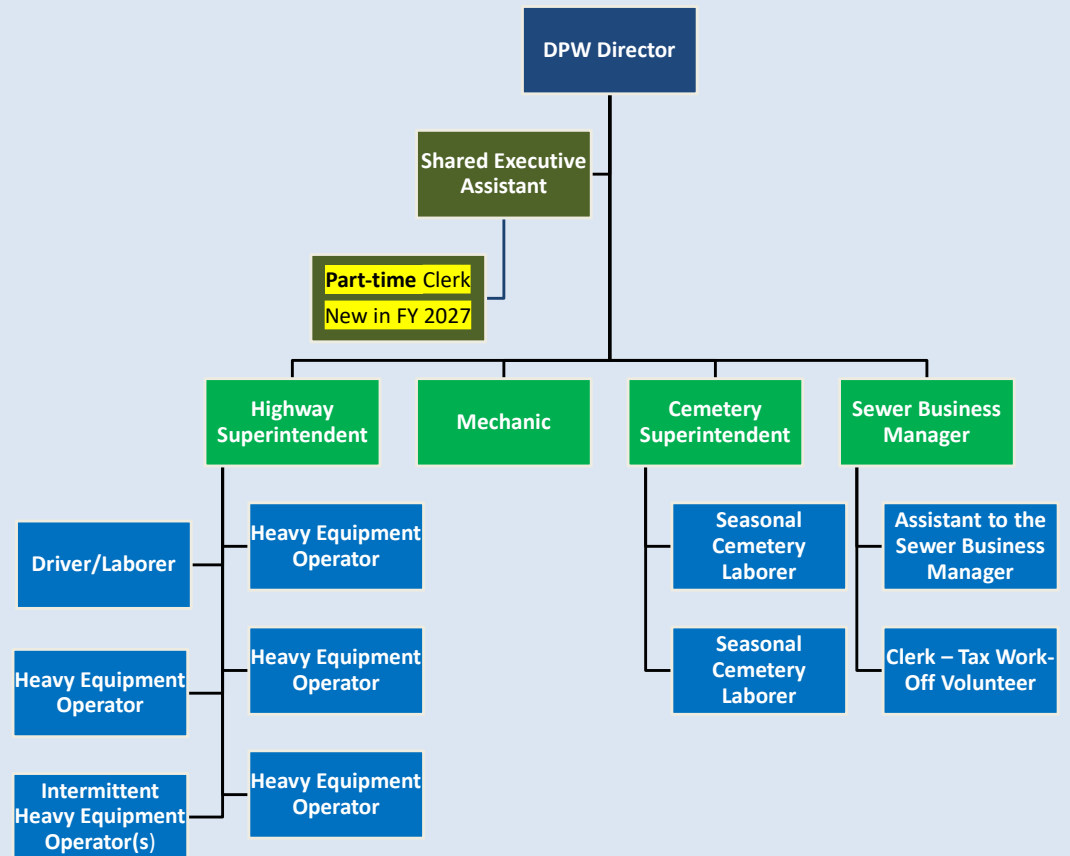
- Highway Division – Roads and all Appurtenances
- Pavement Management
- Stormwater
- Bridges/Culverts
- Trees
- Roadside Vegetation Maintenance
- Landfill monitoring
- Recycle and Trash Program
- Lake Shirley Dam
- Winter Operations
- Cemetery
- Wastewater
- Fleet Maintenance

Organizational Structure

Staffing Overview

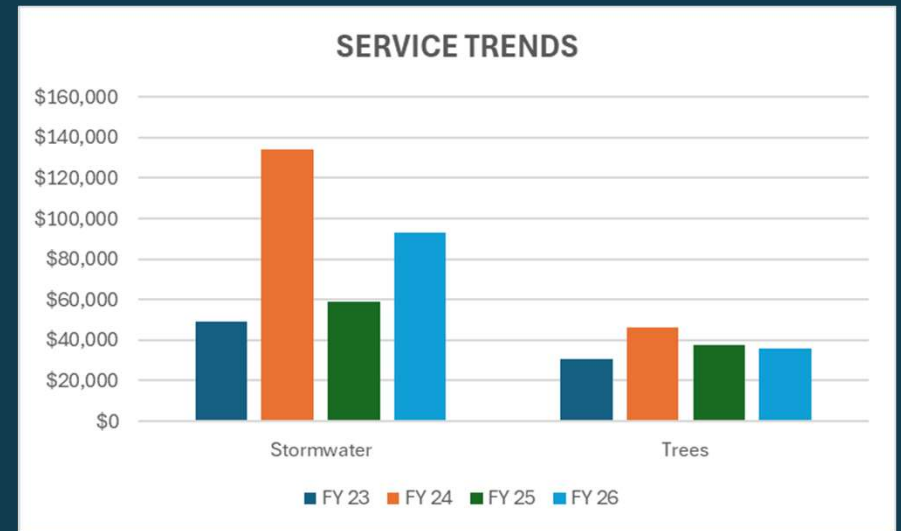
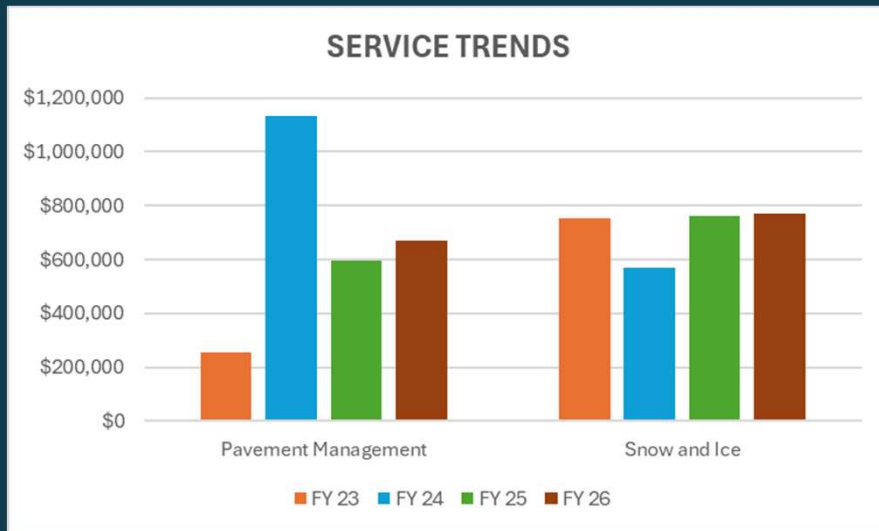
The staff consists of one Director, one Executive Assistant (shared with the Facilities Department), one Highway Superintendent, 4 Heavy Equipment Operators, one Driver/Laborer, one Mechanic, one Cemetery Superintendent, two Seasonal Cemetery Laborers, one Sewer Business Manager, and one Assistant to the Sewer Business Manager.

New for Fiscal Year 2027 is a Part-Time Clerk (non-benefitted).



Service Trends by Fiscal Year

- Increasing costs for:
 - Pavement Management
 - Snow and Ice
 - Stormwater
 - Trees



\$3,178,177.51

Total FY27 Budget Request

The proposed budget of **\$3,178,177.51** reflects a **28.31% increase** from the prior year, ensuring continued delivery of essential services, addressing rising operational costs, restoring Pavement Management Funding, and adding funding for MS4 Compliance. Note the FY 27 Budget is only 9.19% greater than the actual spending in FY 25.

Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	Department
\$30,637.73	\$46,224.66	\$37,509.19	\$38,500.00	\$38,500.00	\$39,500.00	294 Tree Removal
\$416,856.77	\$767,474.54	\$846,662.43	\$888,250.00	\$633,750.00	\$1,375,750.00	411 General Highway Maintenance
\$919.83	\$1,098.73	\$1,099.78	\$1,100.00	\$1,100.00	\$1,100.00	412 Garage
\$8,961.60	\$17,653.91	\$9,214.24	\$12,000.00	\$15,000.00	\$17,500.00	420 HWY OT
\$489,820.35	\$549,761.52	\$603,725.44	\$609,066.45	\$629,443.01	\$681,496.61	421 Highway Labor
\$754,791.96	\$568,589.12	\$763,472.52	\$355,000.16	\$355,571.39	\$364,460.67	423 Snow Removal
\$12,838.26	\$6,741.33	\$12,881.70	\$28,500.00	\$28,500.00	\$16,800.00	425 Traffic Signs & Devices
\$62,482.75	\$55,840.25	\$68,465.44	\$62,750.00	\$62,750.00	\$67,750.00	429 Vehicle Maintenance (DPW only)
\$103,745.60	\$112,167.80	\$106,973.99	\$118,110.48	\$125,338.89	\$123,466.22	491 Cemetery Department
\$99,330.19	\$95,446.48	\$100,855.54	\$112,000.00	\$117,000.00	\$127,000.00	429 Veh Maint Police and Fire
\$332,668.19	\$368,794.70	\$335,085.66	\$469,775.00	\$470,000.00	\$363,354.00	Recycling Program
\$2,313,053.23	\$2,589,793.04	\$2,885,945.93	\$2,695,052.09	\$2,476,953.29	\$3,178,177.51	Totals

Major cost drivers

- Restore Pavement Management
- Add to Stormwater to meet MS4 compliance
- Unknown Salary Increases

Note: This budget is the same as the Town Manager's Preliminary Budget dated 03/03/2026 with one exception. This budget restores Pavement Management to where it would have been with the regular \$50,000 per year increases (\$650,000). The Preliminary Budget has \$279,000 for paving.

Trees

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Salaries Tree Removal	\$930.15	\$1,432.66	\$3,724.19	\$3,000.00	\$3,000.00	\$4,000.00	increase due to increased costs
Tree Removal POS	\$29,707.58	\$44,792.00	\$33,785.00	\$35,000.00	\$35,000.00	\$35,000.00	level fund
Tree Removal Supplies	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$500.00	\$500.00	\$500.00	level fund
Totals	\$30,637.73	\$46,224.66	\$37,509.19	\$38,500.00	\$38,500.00	\$39,500.00	

General Highway

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Gen Hwy Hired Equip	\$159.50	\$377.17	\$19.58	\$750.00	\$750.00	\$750.00	level fund
Gen Hwy Drainage	\$23,282.38	\$82,241.05	\$102,945.53	\$60,000.00	\$75,000.00	\$100,000.00	increase due to backlog of drainage work
Gen Hwy POS	\$27,790.38	\$32,156.68	\$18,963.23	\$45,000.00	\$45,000.00	\$45,000.00	level fund
Gen Hwy Landfill Monitoring	\$6,965.00	\$9,495.00	\$8,452.50	\$7,500.00	\$9,000.00	\$9,000.00	level fund
Gen Hwy Engineering	\$3,575.00	\$0.00	\$2,387.54	\$10,000.00	\$10,000.00	\$10,000.00	level fund
Gen Hwy Lake Shirley Dam	\$10,000.00	\$7,576.72	\$0.00	\$10,000.00	\$10,000.00	\$10,000.00	level fund
Gen Hwy Streetlights	\$0.00	\$30,486.51	\$35,380.97	\$30,000.00	\$30,000.00	\$36,000.00	increase due to increased costs
Gen Hwy Stormwater	\$48,899.92	\$133,825.18	\$59,110.15	\$110,000.00	\$110,000.00	\$450,000.00	*Add \$340K for CB Clean & Sweeping
Gen Hwy ADA ROW	\$27,000.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$30,000.00	\$30,000.00	\$30,000.00	level fund per ADA plan
Gen Hwy Supplies	\$13,132.39	\$17,962.98	\$25,426.12	\$35,000.00	\$35,000.00	\$35,000.00	level fund
Gen Hwy Pavement Mang Plan	\$256,052.20	\$453,353.25	\$593,976.81	\$550,000.00	\$279,000.00	\$650,000.00	scheduled \$50K increase
Totals	\$416,856.77	\$767,474.54	\$846,662.43	\$888,250.00	\$633,750.00	\$1,375,750.00	

Garage Supplies

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Garage Supplies	\$919.83	\$1,098.73	\$1,099.78	\$1,100.00	\$1,100.00	\$1,100.00	level fund
Totals	\$919.83	\$1,098.73	\$1,099.78	\$1,100.00	\$1,100.00	\$1,100.00	

Highway Salaries

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Salaries Hwy OT	\$8,961.60	\$17,653.91	\$9,214.24	\$12,000.00	\$15,000.00	\$17,500.00	increase due to increased costs
Totals	\$8,961.60	\$17,653.91	\$9,214.24	\$12,000.00	\$15,000.00	\$17,500.00	
	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Salaries Hwy Super	\$67,284.23	\$68,701.88	\$68,966.12	\$68,966.22	\$68,966.22	\$68,966.22	*FY 24 Rate - New rates under negotiation
Salaries Hwy Clerical	\$53,455.52	\$60,533.36	\$65,058.72	\$65,058.72	\$68,683.12	\$71,272.56	*FY 26 Rate - New rates under negotiation
NEW FY 27 PT Admin						\$24,150.33	*FY 26 Rate - New rates under negotiation
Salaries Hwy Labor	\$250,818.18	\$288,564.98	\$328,224.24	\$344,918.39	\$344,925.91	\$352,331.42	*FY 24 Rate - New rates under negotiation
Salaries DPW Director	\$96,945.84	\$108,222.40	\$118,118.16	\$105,423.12	\$121,667.76	\$136,576.08	*FY 26 Rate - No FY 27 Rate yet
Salaries Longevity	\$3,200.00	\$4,050.00	\$4,900.00	\$4,900.00	\$5,400.00	\$5,700.00	Estimated - New rates under negotiation
Salaries On-call Stipend	\$6,500.00	\$6,500.00	\$6,500.00	\$6,500.00	\$6,500.00	\$7,800.00	Estimated - New rates under negotiation
Salaries Evaluations	\$3,200.00	\$4,800.00	\$4,550.00	\$5,600.00	\$5,600.00	\$6,300.00	Estimated - New rates under negotiation
Hwy Labor Uniforms	\$8,416.58	\$8,388.90	\$7,408.20	\$7,700.00	\$7,700.00	\$8,400.00	Estimated - New rates under negotiation
Totals	\$489,820.35	\$549,761.52	\$603,725.44	\$609,066.45	\$629,443.01	\$681,496.61	

Highway Salaries

The Collective Bargaining Agreement for the DPW Workers Union expired in 2024. Therefore, they have not had any cost-of-living increases in two years. They are actively negotiating a new agreement at this time. All potential salaries increases are unknown at this time. To give a sense of how much funding might be required, a 3% increase was assumed for FY 25, FY 26, and another for FY 27.

The Collective Bargaining Agree for the Clerical Unition expires in FY 26. They are actively negotiating a new agreement at this time. All potential salaries increases are unknown at this time. To give a sense of how much funding might be required, a 3% increase was assumed for FY 27.

There are no cost-of-living increases for the SAP at this time. To give a sense of how much funding might be required, a 3% increase was assumed for FY 27.

A total costs of \$51,696.16 was calculated. This does not include any potential retroactive pay for overtime.

Snow and Ice

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Salaries Snow OT	\$84,398.51	\$48,591.87	\$75,992.24	\$22,849.16	\$23,420.39	\$24,005.90	2.5% increase, will require deficit spending
Snow Contracted Services	\$364,165.54	\$273,155.22	\$400,802.30	\$114,500.00	\$114,500.00	\$117,362.50	2.5% increase, will require deficit spending
Snow Purchase of Service	\$0.00	\$26,271.64	\$2,713.00	\$5,000.00	\$5,000.00	\$5,125.00	2.5% increase, will require deficit spending
Snow Supplies	\$306,227.91	\$220,570.39	\$267,633.76	\$205,151.00	\$205,151.00	\$210,279.78	2.5% increase, will require deficit spending
Snow Hired Eq	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$16,331.22	\$7,500.00	\$7,500.00	\$7,687.50	2.5% increase, will require deficit spending
Totals	\$754,791.96	\$568,589.12	\$763,472.52	\$355,000.16	\$355,571.39	\$364,460.67	

Traffic Signs

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Traffic Signs Electricity	\$991.11	\$931.39	\$1,176.17	\$1,000.00	\$1,000.00	\$1,300.00	increase due to increased costs
Traffic Signs Line Painting	\$4,165.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$17,500.00	\$17,500.00	\$5,500.00	Stop bars and crosswalks only (<i>grant</i>)
Traffic Signs Supplies	\$7,682.15	\$5,809.94	\$11,705.53	\$10,000.00	\$10,000.00	\$10,000.00	level fund
Totals	\$12,838.26	\$6,741.33	\$12,881.70	\$28,500.00	\$28,500.00	\$16,800.00	

DPW Vehicle Maintenance

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Veh MTC DPW POS	\$8,305.45	\$3,668.88	\$20,122.03	\$5,000.00	\$5,000.00	\$10,000.00	increase due to increased costs
Veh MTC DPW Tools	\$634.52	\$649.99	\$667.98	\$750.00	\$750.00	\$750.00	level fund
Veh MTC DPW Supplies	\$24,336.48	\$25,840.12	\$23,563.77	\$25,000.00	\$25,000.00	\$25,000.00	level fund
Veh MTC DPW Fuel	\$29,206.30	\$25,681.26	\$24,111.66	\$32,000.00	\$32,000.00	\$32,000.00	level fund
Totals	\$62,482.75	\$55,840.25	\$68,465.44	\$62,750.00	\$62,750.00	\$67,750.00	

Name of Budget	FY 23	FY 24	FY 25 actual	FY 25 original	FY 26	FY 27	Comments
POS Police	\$6,523.53	\$9,563.22	\$2,566.26	\$9,000.00	\$9,000.00	\$9,000.00	level fund
Veh Mt Police Supplies	\$11,499.70	\$17,189.70	\$16,170.30	\$18,000.00	\$18,000.00	\$18,000.00	level fund
Fuel Police	\$36,956.57	\$35,139.54	\$28,936.72	\$40,000.00	\$40,000.00	\$40,000.00	level fund
POS Fire	\$16,940.92	\$11,247.26	\$28,238.52	\$17,000.00	\$17,000.00	\$27,000.00	Increase
Veh Mt Fire Supplies	\$7,047.71	\$6,831.12	\$9,513.85	\$10,000.00	\$15,000.00	\$15,000.00	level fund
Fuel Fire	\$20,361.76	\$15,475.64	\$15,429.89	\$18,000.00	\$18,000.00	\$18,000.00	level fund
Totals	\$99,330.19	\$95,446.48	\$100,855.54	\$112,000.00	\$117,000.00	\$127,000.00	

Cemetery

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Salaries Cmtry Super Salary	\$62,480.01	\$65,391.56	\$67,284.23	\$67,284.13	\$74,012.54	\$68,966.22	*FY 24 Rate - New rates under negotiation
Salaries Cmtry Seasonal Salaries	\$11,634.19	\$1,804.00	\$14,169.36	\$14,476.35	\$14,476.35	\$15,000.00	increase due to increased costs
Salaries Cmtry OT Supervisor	\$3,250.19	\$4,479.98	\$2,948.54	\$3,500.00	\$4,000.00	\$4,000.00	level fund
Salaries Cmtry Longevity	\$850.00	\$850.00	\$850.00	\$1,350.00	\$1,350.00	\$1,400.00	Estimated - New rates under negotiation
Salaries Cmtry Contract Eval	\$800.00	\$0.00	\$800.00	\$800.00	\$800.00	\$900.00	Estimated - New rates under negotiation
Cemetery POS	\$18,691.06	\$29,278.41	\$12,470.04	\$22,000.00	\$22,000.00	\$22,000.00	level fund
Cemetery Supplies	\$1,006.80	\$6,384.01	\$5,653.80	\$3,000.00	\$3,000.00	\$5,500.00	increase due to increased costs
Cemetery Fuel Charges	\$3,862.48	\$3,215.71	\$1,752.01	\$3,500.00	\$3,500.00	\$3,500.00	level fund
Cemetery Uniforms	\$1,170.87	\$764.13	\$1,046.01	\$2,200.00	\$2,200.00	\$2,200.00	Estimated - New rates under negotiation
Totals	\$103,745.60	\$112,167.80	\$106,973.99	\$118,110.48	\$125,338.89	\$123,466.22	

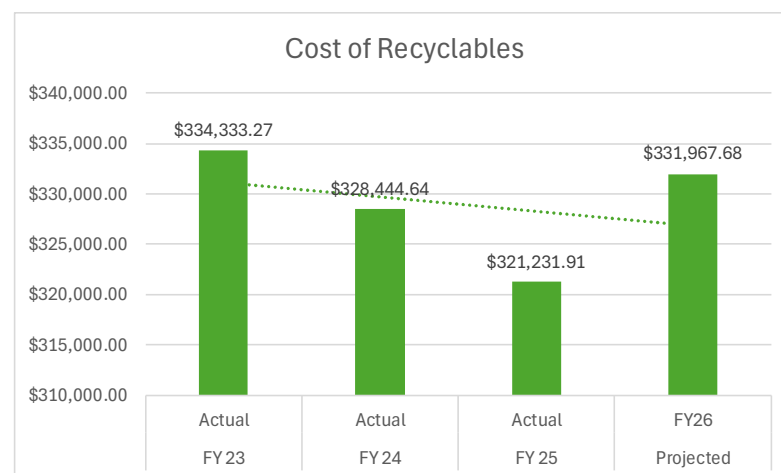
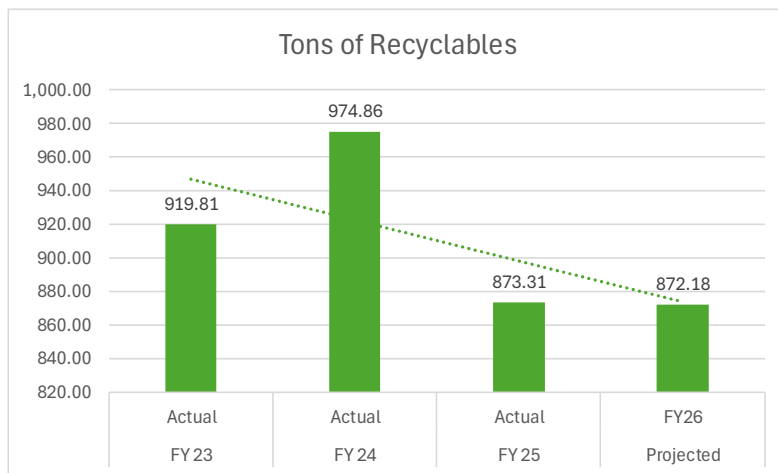
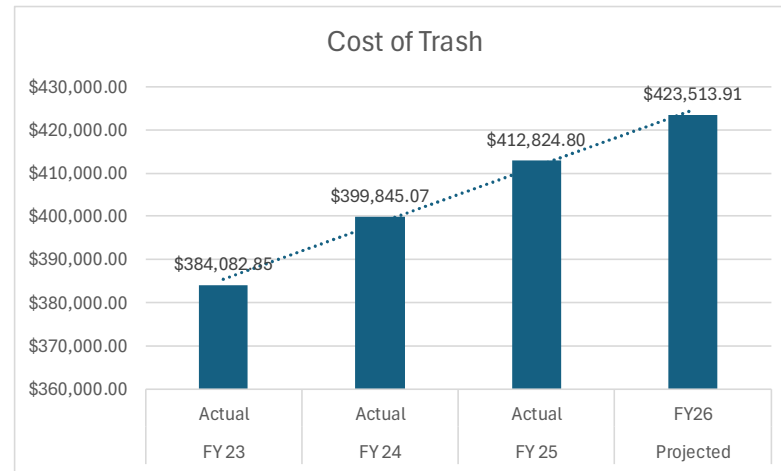
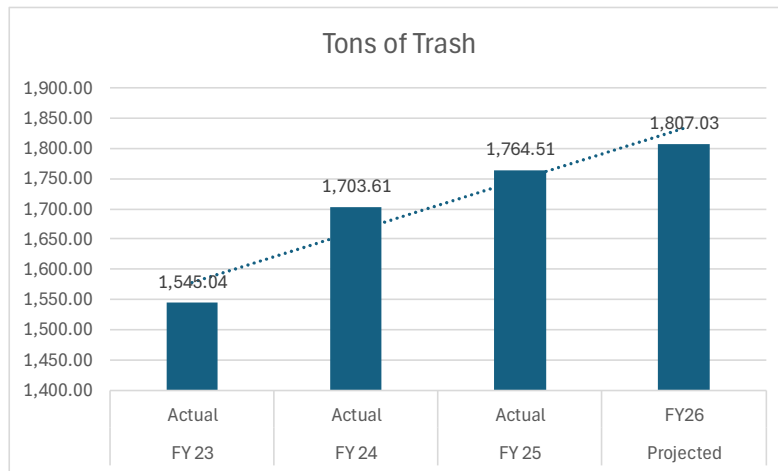
Recycling Program

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
Expenses Recycling Program	\$320,280.19	\$356,265.70	\$322,327.66	\$457,000.00	\$456,757.00	\$350,000.00	Per calculation
Household Hazardous Waste	\$5,354.00	\$5,354.00	\$5,404.00	\$5,600.00	\$5,889.00	\$6,000.00	increase due to increased costs
Dues/Membership	\$7,034.00	\$7,175.00	\$7,354.00	\$7,175.00	\$7,354.00	\$7,354.00	level fund
	\$332,668.19	\$368,794.70	\$335,085.66	\$469,775.00	\$470,000.00	\$363,354.00	

Trash (PAYT)

Note: this is a self funding program outside of the DPW Budget

	Actual Spending FY 23	Actual Spending FY 24	Actual Spending FY 25	Original Budget FY 25	Original Budget FY 26	Preliminary Budget FY 27	
Name of Budget							Comments
POS Solid Waste (PAYT)	\$382,744.31	\$503,055.79	\$477,932.42	\$500,000.00	\$500,000.00	\$500,000.00	level fund
Bags/Bin Revenue	-\$395,376.80	-\$502,453.72	-\$502,615.30	-\$499,850.00	-\$499,850.00	-\$500,000.00	level fund
	-\$12,632.49	\$602.07	-\$24,682.88		\$150.00	\$0.00	



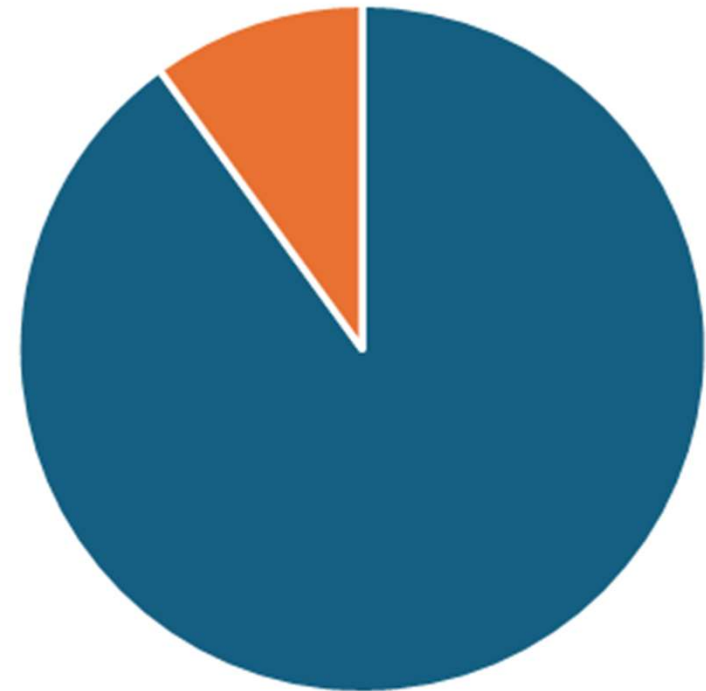
Funding Sources

The DPW's funding is from the General Fund ensuring fiscal responsibility and transparency while maintaining essential services for our community.

Chapter 90 funds are used for pavement management and construction projects.

The DPW applies for grants for construction projects whenever possible.

FUNDING SOURCES



■ General Fund ■ Ch 90 and Grants

Grants and Other Funding

Overview of Funding Sources

Active Grants

- MassDOT Small Bridge Grant for \$600,000
 - Flat Hill Road over the Catacoonamug Brook
- Asset Management Grant from Mass Clean Water Trust for \$59,565
 - Map Catch basins and connecting pipes

Future Grants to Explore

- Applied for a MassDOT Community Culvert Grant Program, \$150,000 for engineering
 - Goodrich Street over Easter Brook
- Applying for a MassDOT Complete Streets grant for sidewalk construction for \$1,000,000
 - Northfield Road, Chestnut Street, etc.

The grants the DPW receive and the Chapter 90 funds do not supplement the Operational Budget.

The grants and Chapter 90 funds supplement Capital Funding requests as they are used for bigger projects that are not done using operational funds.

Chapter 90 Spending Plan

This assumes the Pavement
Management Line Item is
Reduced

Anticipated Usage of Chapter 90 Funds - PMP Line Item is Reduced		
\$2,047,102.88 Balance as of Septemer 2025		
Fiscal Year 2026 July 1, 2025 to June 30, 2026		
Estimated Cost	Balance	Description of Project
\$883,172	\$2,930,275	Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2026
\$119,000	\$2,811,275	Engineering for Sidewalk improvements
\$411,000	\$2,400,275	FY 26 PMP
\$530,000	total anticipated spending	
Fiscal Year 2027 July 1, 2026 to June 30, 2027		
Estimated Cost		Description of Project
\$415,000	\$2,400,275	Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2027
\$500,000	\$1,900,275	Sidewalk Improvments and New Sidewalks on Chestnut St and Northfield Road
\$75,000	\$1,825,275	Drainage Swales at 181 Reservoir Road
\$250,000	\$1,575,275	Drainage Improvements on Laurel Lane
\$150,000	\$1,425,275	Drainage Improvements at 32 Hemlock Drive
\$400,000	\$1,025,275	FY 27 PMP
\$1,375,000	total anticipated spending	
Fiscal Year 2028 July 1, 2027 to June 30, 2028		
Estimated Cost		Description of Project
\$415,000	\$1,440,275	Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2028
\$900,000	\$540,275	Construction of Culvert Replacement - Goodrich Street over Easter Brook
\$450,000	\$90,275	FY 28 PMP
\$450,000	total anticipated spending	
Fiscal Year 2029 July 1, 2028 to June 30, 2029		
Estimated Cost		Description of Project
\$415,000	\$505,275	Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2029
\$500,000	\$5,275	FY 29 PMP
\$500,000	total anticipated spending	
Fiscal Year 2030 July 1, 2029 to June 30, 2030		
Estimated Cost		Description of Project
\$415,000	\$420,275	Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2030
\$420,000	\$275	FY 30 PMP
\$420,000	total anticipated spending	

Chapter 90 Spending Plan

This assumes the Pavement
Management Line Item is
Restored

Anticipated Usage of Chapter 90 Funds - PMP Line Item is Restored		
\$2,047,102.88 Balance as of September 2025		
Fiscal Year 2026 July 1, 2025 to June 30, 2026		
Estimated Cost	Balance	Description of Project
\$883,172	\$2,930,275	Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2026
\$75,000	\$2,855,275	Drainage Swales at 181 Reservoir Road
\$250,000	\$2,605,275	Drainage Improvements on Laurel Lane
\$150,000	\$2,455,275	Drainage Improvements at 32 Hemlock Drive
\$500,000	\$1,955,275	Sidewalk Improvments and New Sidewalks on Chestnut St and Northfield Road
\$311,000	\$1,644,275	FY 26 PMP
\$112,500	\$1,531,775	Engineering for culvert replacement, Goodrich Street over Easter Brook
\$1,398,500	total anticipated spending	
Fiscal Year 2027 July 1, 2026 to June 30, 2027		
Estimated Cost	Description of Project	
\$415,000	\$1,946,775 Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2027	
\$900,000	\$1,046,775 Construction of Culvert Replacement - Goodrich Street over Easter Brook	
\$100,000	\$946,775 FY 27 PMP	
\$1,000,000	total anticipated spending	
Fiscal Year 2028 July 1, 2027 to June 30, 2028		
Estimated Cost	Description of Project	
\$415,000	\$1,361,775 Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2028	
\$700,000	\$661,775 Various Drainage Repairs and Upgrades	
\$120,000	\$541,775 FY 28 PMP	
\$820,000	total anticipated spending	
Fiscal Year 2029 July 1, 2028 to June 30, 2029		
Estimated Cost	Description of Project	
\$415,000	\$956,775 Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2029	
\$525,000	\$431,775 Various Drainage Repairs and Upgrades	
\$170,000	\$261,775 FY 29 PMP	
\$695,000	total anticipated spending	
Fiscal Year 2030 July 1, 2029 to June 30, 2030		
Estimated Cost	Description of Project	
\$415,000	\$676,775 Anticipated Chapter 90 Funding in Fiscal Year 2030	
\$220,000	\$456,775 Various Drainage Repairs and Upgrades	
\$200,000	\$256,775 FY 30 PMP	
\$420,000	total anticipated spending	

FY27 Summary & Recap

If the Pavement Management line item is not restored, Chapter 90 funds will be used for pavement management. Future bridge/culvert/drainage projects that have been earmarked for Chapter 90 funds will need to be funded by increased Capital Funds.

If the additional \$340,000 is not added to the Stormwater line item, we will continue to NOT meet the requirements of the MS4 Permit. This will result in further impairment of the Town's water bodies and risk expensive fines from the EPA.



THANK YOU!
ANY QUESTIONS?

William Bernard, DPW Director, March 12 , 2026